

Ranges, Ovens and Gas Connections

The tipping hazard, the gas line rule, and the one thing you are expected to operate on an oven.

YOU HAVE MISSED THIS 3 TIMES

A free-standing electric range requires a/an:
Anti-tip device.

A free-standing range is not fixed to anything. Open the door, put weight on it — a child climbing, or a heavy dish — and the whole appliance can tip forward. The anti-tip bracket screws to the floor or wall and catches a foot of the range. It is a genuine safety item and one of the most commonly missing things in a kitchen, because it is invisible unless you look behind.

The numbers here

Flexible gas connector behind a free-standing gas range — maximum length	6 ft
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Microwave oven — minimum height from the floor to the top of the unit	66 in
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YOU HAVE MISSED THIS 2 TIMES

What is the maximum length of a flexible gas connector behind a free-standing gas range?
Six feet.

A flexible connector is the weak point of a gas installation: it can be kinked, abraded or pulled apart. Six feet is the limit, and the same rule family says a connector must never be concealed, run through a wall, or joined to another connector. Texas is explicit about both the length and the concealment.

YOU HAVE MISSED THIS 2 TIMES

Most microwave oven manufacturers recommend that there is at least ____ between the floor and the top of the unit.
66 inches.

Sixty-six inches is five feet six — roughly eye level. Above that, someone of average height reaching in cannot see into a dish of boiling liquid they are lifting out over their own face.

Inspecting the oven

YOU HAVE MISSED THIS 2 TIMES

When inspecting an oven, the inspector should:
Check the operation of the self-clean lock lever.

You do not run a self-clean cycle — it takes hours and can destroy a marginal oven. What you check is that the lock lever operates, because the lock is the safety device that keeps the door shut while the cavity is at cleaning temperature.

Texas checks the oven thermostat, the national standard largely does not

For the Texas state portion, an oven thermostat must hold within 25 degrees at a 350 degree F setting. Texas inspects appliances explicitly; the national standard mostly leaves them out.

Say it back

Cover the page. Answer each one out loud.

1. What does a free-standing electric range require, and why?
2. Maximum length of a flexible gas connector, and two other rules about them?
3. Minimum height to the top of a microwave, and the reason behind it?
4. What do you check on an oven, and what do you not do?
5. What is the Texas oven thermostat tolerance?